

Intel goes 25nm

Intel moves to 25nm on their flash memory

ASUS 3D displays

ASUS launches two new 3D displays VG236H and PG276; 3D glasses will be bundled

(with a homescreen widget) YouTube, Rally Master (simple accelerometer-based car-racing game), SSX 3 (accelerometer-based snowboarding game), WorldMate (travel planner), GTalk, Google Maps (without multitouch, of course), TrackID (song identifier) and Facebook. But we detest the point and click interface of the OS, where you accomplish tasks through two presses, one to highlight and other to select.

The saving grace is probably that compatible Symbian software can be downloaded from the net. The browsing experience is poor owing to the resistive screen and occasional crashing of the browser due to low memory, restricting operation to lowly WAP sites. Equally pathetic are the bundled headphones, which had miserable audio output, and didn't even come with foam!

The Verdict:

We agree that the Vivaz truly holds its own in the photo/video capture segment rendering high-definition video at consistent frame rates with an enviable colour clarity and crispness. It is to be noted that it has been advertised for its capabilities as a HD movie playback and recording phone, and it unnervingly lives up to these expectations. We fail to understand how a device that boasts of hardware specs similar to the Apple iPhone 3GS or the same processor as the Motorola Milestone have such bad performance and low features. We wouldn't have mind it at all if the gimmick of touchscreen was avoided and the phone released with a keypad. We would have appreciated it just as a thin snapper that makes

calls. The Xperia X10, another full touchscreen and 8MP camera bearing mobile from Sony Ericsson, is also a comparable product, marginally more expensive, but providing a snazzier Timescape-inspired Android 1.6 OS.

Sony Ericsson Aino

The Sony Ericsson Aino introduces Remote Play that enables the phone to playback the Media content on your PlayStation 3 console. The sleek and stylish Aino comes with a bluemoon silver metal lining decorating the smooth contours of the body, with an elegant sculpted matte finish on the front and back panel. It has a hard plastic battery cover that clings on neatly to the body frame.

The volume/camera zoom control and camera buttons blend into the metallic lining across the contours of the body frame. In addition, it has a sliding keypad with protruding, well spaced keys. A special notable accessory is the docking station that allows the user to slate the mobile horizontally, suitable for movies.

The Verdict:

The Sony Ericsson Aino stands out for Camera and Multimedia abilities, but its USP is Remote Play and you could give it good thought if you own a PS3. It holds the pole position in the phone earpiece

volume and bundled ear-phones test, scoring 10 on 10 in each category with exemplary performance in terms of producing consistent voice clarity and balanced sound output without rough overtones, even at maximum volume.

It had a consistent outing in all the other tests. It also ran very close on the heels of Vivaz in the video playback quality test while not doing so well in the captured video quality test. With the final results tipping the scales in favor of Aino, it remains one of the top performer considering the overall score across all the tests. It has an estimated price tag of Rs. 28,950 and hence about Rs. 3,300 dearer than the Vivaz model. Aino is the among the best phones tested, finishing with an overall score of 8.5.

Conclusion

The innumerable other functions we have come to expect of high-end phones nowadays should not be counted out, and this is where the device which offers the most under will be the winner: the Nokia N97 Mini, a 3.2-inch, horizontal sliding QWERTY phone with blazing connectivity speeds and superb battery life and media playback quality, our Best Buy.

Lifestyle phones (32,001 and above)

The final word in the mobile space, these devices are much, much more than just phones. Offering unbelievable

multi-functionality, these phones are near PC-replacement devices, with a very wide range of applications to choose from, and running on advanced operating systems and some seriously capable hardware. Bringing augmented reality a step closer to the real world, the Sony Ericsson Xperia X10, Apple iPhone 3GS, and Motorola Milestone are the flagship devices of their companies, and it is hard to find fault in any of them.

Sony Ericsson Xperia X10

A phone that was painstakingly developed at Sony Ericsson, the Xperia X10 at Rs. 35,795 is the current flagship device from the company, featuring a heavily customised Android OS, and lots of top-end features.

The phone is certainly fun to use, with a responsive capacitive touchscreen, a rather uniquely customized OS, signature Timescape and Mediascape applications, and access to the Android marketplace. Call clarity is good, with an exceptional loudspeaker and earpiece. The handsfree however provides pretty muted sound to the person you are talking to.

The screen is exceptionally bright in sunlight, and has a scratch-resistant surface. The Xperia X10 has a not-so unique keypad layout, with a Menu key, Home, and a Back key. The notification area is also easy to use, sliding down to not interrupt your work. The phone also makes full use of its 1GHz processor with its task switcher, which can be called up if you hold the Home key.

However, with all its major advantages and speedy operation, the phone has some serious flaws as well, such

Sony Ericsson Aino

